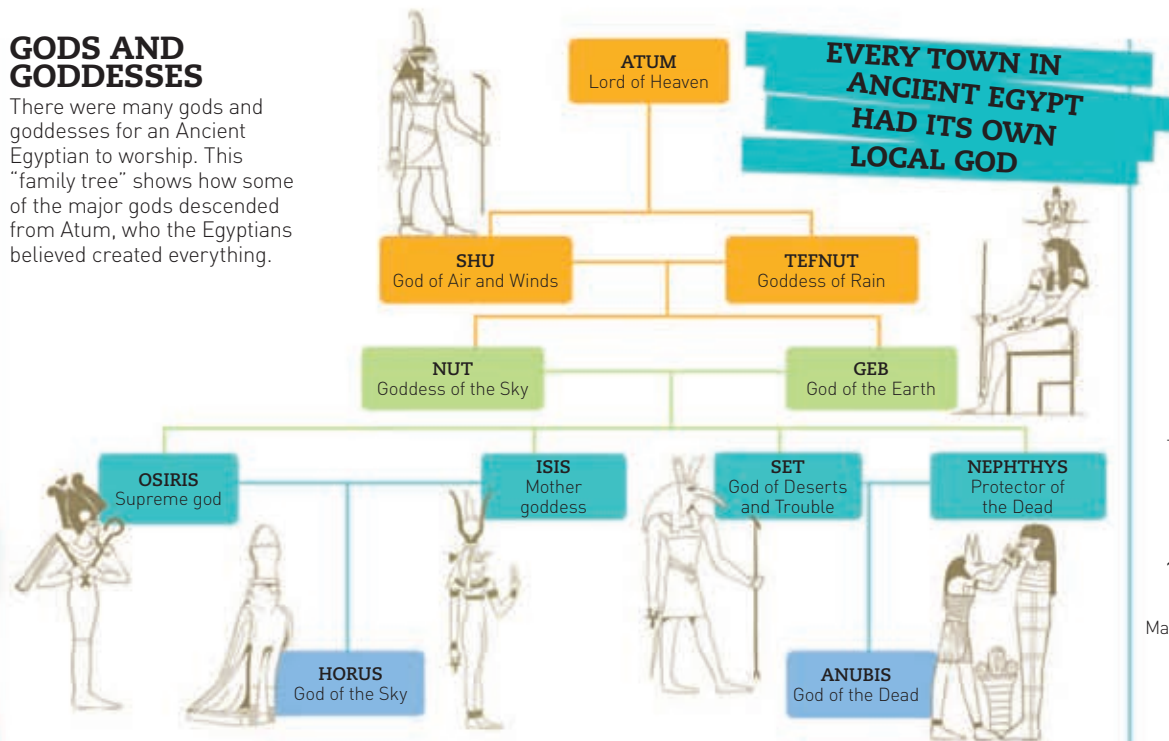


GODS AND GODDESSES

There were many gods and goddesses for an Ancient Egyptian to worship. This "family tree" shows how some of the major gods descended from Atum, who the Egyptians believed created everything.



HIEROGLYPHS

Ancient Egyptian writing used pictures or signs called hieroglyphs. Each one could mean a sound, a word, or an action. The "alphabet" seen here shows some hieroglyphs and how they might be pronounced today. Instead of writing on paper, the Egyptians used flattened sheets of a type of reed called papyrus.

a	a	b	kh	h	tj	d	a/i
g	h	kh	j	k	m	n	w/u
p	k	r	sh	s	t	f	s

JEWELLERY

The Ancient Egyptians prized jewellery. Rings, necklaces, and amulets in the form of sacred symbols were popular. Jewellery worn by rich people was often made of gold and valuable stones.



WINGED SCARAB AMULET



GOLD AMULET



EARRING



FINGER RINGS



BEAD NECKLACE

HISTORY OF ANCIENT EGYPT

The Ancient Egyptian civilization lasted for more than 3,000 years, with hundreds of different rulers, both good and bad. Historians have divided up this very long timespan into major dynasties (ruling families), kingdoms, and periods.

EARLY DYNASTIC PERIOD

c.3000-2686 BCE
Organized government under the rule of the pharaohs begins. People start to use hieroglyphs.

3000 BCE



The Sphinx at Giza

OLD KINGDOM

2686-2125 BCE
The great pyramids and the Sphinx are built at Giza.



Slab for mixing ointment, made around 2000 BCE

1ST INTERMEDIATE PERIOD

2160-2055 BCE
Many power struggles between dynasties.

MIDDLE KINGDOM

2055-1650 BCE
Life is more settled. Improved irrigation produces better crops.



Bead collar

2ND INTERMEDIATE PERIOD

1650-1550 BCE
More unrest, with wars and invasions.



Arrowheads

NEW KINGDOM

1550-1069 BCE
Egypt conquers many lands. Famous pharaohs include Tutankhamun.



Statuette of slave girl

3RD INTERMEDIATE PERIOD

1069-664 BCE
Assyrians conquer Egypt.

LATE PERIOD

664-332 BCE
Time of much temple building and animal mummifying.

PTOLEMAIC DYNASTY

332-30 BCE
Cleopatra VII, the last pharaoh, dies. Rome conquers Egypt.

30 BCE



Coin showing the head of Cleopatra



Painted mummy case, portraying the dead person

Scenes from the Underworld

Spread wings were a common decoration

Traditional sacred symbols of cross and pillar